



2026

History & Geography

Grade 5 · Paper 4 of 4

Theme: Mauritius Independence, Physical Features & Cultural Celebrations

Time allowed: **1 hour** Total marks: **50**

Name: _____

Class: _____ Date: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, class and date in the spaces above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all three sections.
3. For tick-box questions, place a clear tick (✓) in the box next to your chosen answer.
4. Write your answers neatly in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the answer boxes.
5. The marks available for each question are shown in the box on the right.
6. Read each question carefully before you answer.

Mark allocation: Section A — History (25 marks) | Section B — Geography (15 marks) | Section C — Civics (10 marks)

Section A — History of Mauritius [25 marks]

1 For each question below, tick (✓) ONE correct answer.

(a) On which date did Mauritius become an independent nation? 1

☐ 1 January 1968

☐ 12 March 1968

☐ 12 March 1992

☐ 1 May 1968

(b) Who was the first Prime Minister of Mauritius after independence? 1

☐ Sir Anerood Jugnauth

☐ Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam

☐ Paul Bérenger

☐ Navin Ramgoolam

(c) In which year did Mauritius become a *Republic*, with a President as Head of State? 1

☐ 1968

☐ 1982

☐ 1992

☐ 2000

(d) Mauritius remained a member of which international organisation even after becoming a Republic? 1

☐ The African Union

☐ The Commonwealth of Nations

☐ The United Nations Security Council

☐ The European Union

2 Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

5

"On 12 March 1968, thousands of Mauritians gathered in Port Louis for a historic moment. The British flag, the Union Jack, was lowered for the last time, and the new four-coloured flag of Mauritius rose in its place — red, blue, yellow and green. Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam, the leader of the independence movement and the country's first Prime Minister, had guided his people to freedom through peaceful negotiation rather than violence. He became known as the 'Father of the Nation'. Twenty-four years later, on 12 March 1992, Mauritius became a Republic — choosing its own President as Head of State — while remaining part of the Commonwealth. The date 12 March is celebrated as National Day every year."

- (a)** Name the flag that was lowered when Mauritius became independent.
[1 mark]

- (b)** According to the passage, how did Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam achieve independence for Mauritius? What title did he earn as a result? [2 marks]

- (c)** The passage mentions two important events both happening on 12 March. Name both events and their years. [2 marks]

- 3 Describe THREE important changes that independence brought to the people of Mauritius. Write two or three sentences for each change.** 6

(a) Change 1:

(b) Change 2:

(c) Change 3:

- 4 Answer the following short questions about independence and the modern history of Mauritius.** 5

(a) What is the difference between an independent country and a *colony*?
[2 marks]

(b) Name ONE important right that Mauritian citizens gained after independence that they did not have under British rule. [1 mark]

(c) What do the four colours of the Mauritian flag represent? Complete the table below. [2 marks — ½ mark each]

Colour	What it represents
Red	
Blue	
Yellow	
Green	

5 **Why was independence so important for the people of Mauritius?** In your answer, explain what life might have been like under colonial rule and how independence changed things. Refer to at least TWO specific improvements.

5

Section B — Geography of Mauritius [15 marks]

6 Tick (✓) **ONE** correct answer for each question.

(a) What is the name of the highest mountain peak in Mauritius?

1

- ☐ Le Morne Brabant
- ☐ Piton de la Petite Rivière Noire
- ☐ Pieter Both
- ☐ Corps de Garde

(b) The Central Plateau of Mauritius lies at approximately what altitude above sea level?

1

- ☐ 100–200 metres
- ☐ 300–400 metres
- ☐ 500–600 metres
- ☐ 800–900 metres

(c) The Black River Gorges National Park is an important protected area. In which part of Mauritius is it located?

1

- ☐ Northeast
- ☐ Southwest
- ☐ Southeast
- ☐ Northwest

7 Answer the following questions about the physical features of Mauritius.

6

(a) Describe what the **Central Plateau** of Mauritius is, and name **TWO** towns or cities found on it. [3 marks]

(b) Mauritius is surrounded by **coral reefs**. Describe **ONE** benefit these reefs provide to the island. [1 mark]

- (c) Name ONE coastal feature of Mauritius (e.g. a bay, lagoon or beach). Explain why this feature is important for tourism or fishing. [2 marks]

8 Study the outline map description below and answer the questions.

6

Mauritius is a small island of about 1,865 km² located in the Indian Ocean, approximately 2,000 km off the east coast of Africa. The island has a roughly oval shape. The terrain rises from the coast towards a central plateau. Major rivers flow outwards from the central highlands towards the coast. The island's coastline has many bays, lagoons and white sandy beaches. It also has a smaller island dependency called Rodrigues, located about 560 km to the northeast.

- (a) What is the total land area of the main island of Mauritius, according to the description? [1 mark]

- (b) In which direction from Mauritius is Rodrigues Island located? [1 mark]

- (c) Explain why rivers in Mauritius generally flow *outward* from the centre of the island towards the coast. [2 marks]

- (d) Name ONE ocean that surrounds Mauritius. [1 mark]

(e) Approximately how far is Mauritius from the east coast of Africa? [1 mark]

Section C — Civics & Cultural Celebrations [10 marks]

9 Tick (✓) ONE correct answer for each question.

(a) Which festival marks the beginning of the Chinese New Year in Mauritius, celebrated with firecrackers and dragon dances?

1

- ☐ Diwali
- ☐ Chinese Spring Festival (Gong Xi Fa Cai)
- ☐ Mid-Autumn Festival
- ☐ Holi

(b) *Maha Shivaratri* is a major festival in Mauritius where pilgrims walk long distances to a sacred lake. What is the name of that lake?

1

- ☐ Bagatelle Reservoir
- ☐ Grand Bassin (Ganga Talao)
- ☐ Mare aux Vacoas
- ☐ Blue Bay Lagoon

(c) *Creole Day* (Jounn Kréol Internasional) celebrates the Creole language and culture. In which month is it held each year in Mauritius?

1

- ☐ March
- ☐ July
- ☐ October
- ☐ December

(d) The Mauritian national anthem is called:

1

- ☐ "Glory to thee, Mauritius"
- ☐ "Motherland"
- ☐ "Isle of the Indian Ocean"
- ☐ "Star of the Sea"

10 Answer the following questions about cultural celebrations in Mauritius.

6

(a) Describe ONE cultural festival or celebration in Mauritius. In your answer, state: the name of the festival, which community celebrates it, and how it is celebrated. [3 marks]

- (b)** Many different religions are practised in Mauritius. Give TWO reasons why it is important for all Mauritians to respect each other's religions and celebrations. [2 marks]

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for the student to write their two reasons for respecting different religions and celebrations in Mauritius.

- (c)** Mauritius is sometimes called a "model of harmony" among nations. What do you think this means? Give ONE example that supports this idea. [1 mark]

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for the student to write their explanation of what "model of harmony" means and provide one supporting example.

Mark Scheme — Paper 4 (Independence, Physical Features & Cultural Celebrations)

For teacher / parent use only. Accept any answer that is factually correct and demonstrates understanding. For extended answers, award marks for each developed point rather than counting sentences. The mark scheme gives the most likely answers; other correct responses should receive full credit.

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1(a)	12 March 1968	1
1(b)	Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam	1
1(c)	1992	1
1(d)	The Commonwealth of Nations	1
2(a)	The Union Jack (the British flag)	1
2(b)	He achieved independence through peaceful negotiation (not violence) (1 mark). He was known as the "Father of the Nation" (1 mark).	2
2(c)	Independence on 12 March 1968 (1 mark); Mauritius became a Republic on 12 March 1992 (1 mark).	2
3(a–c)	Any THREE from: Mauritius gained self-government / own elected Parliament; the people could vote for their own leaders; a new national flag and anthem were adopted; foreign policy became independent; the economy was no longer controlled by Britain; free education was introduced; National Day could be celebrated; Mauritians had their own passport / citizenship. 2 marks per well-explained change; 1 mark for bare statement.	6
4(a)	An independent country governs itself and makes its own laws (1 mark); a colony is ruled and controlled by another country (1 mark).	2
4(b)	Any valid right: the right to vote in free elections; the right to choose their own government; freedom of religion / speech / press; right to a Mauritian passport / citizenship. (1 mark for any valid answer)	1
4(c)	Red — the struggle for independence / bloodshed of independence (½ mark); Blue — the Indian Ocean (½ mark); Yellow — the light of independence / the bright future / sunlight (½ mark); Green — the vegetation / agriculture of the island (½ mark).	2
5	Award 2 marks per specific improvement explained (up to 4 marks) + 1 mark for overall quality. Improvements may include: the right to vote and choose leaders; freedom to celebrate own culture / language; economic development controlled by Mauritians; national pride / identity; free education / healthcare; own laws and constitution. Partial credit for bare mention.	5

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
6(a)	Piton de la Petite Rivière Noire	1
6(b)	500–600 metres	1
6(c)	Southwest	1
7(a)	The Central Plateau is a flat, elevated area in the middle of Mauritius at roughly 500–600m above sea level (1 mark). Any TWO towns: Curepipe, Vacoas, Phoenix, Rose-Hill, Quatre Bornes, Beau Bassin (1 mark each, up to 2 marks total).	3
7(b)	Any valid benefit: protect the coast from waves / erosion; provide habitat for fish and marine life; support fishing industry; attract tourists; act as a natural barrier against cyclone waves; form lagoons of calm water. (1 mark for a developed answer)	1
7(c)	Any named coastal feature, e.g. Blue Bay, Grand Bay, Tamarin Bay, Mahebourg Bay, Le Morne Peninsula (1 mark). Explanation of importance for tourism (beaches attract visitors / income) or fishing (sheltered bay supports fishing boats / catch) (1 mark).	2
8(a)	Approximately 1,865 km ²	1
8(b)	Northeast	1
8(c)	The central plateau / highlands are the highest point of the island (1 mark), so water naturally flows downhill from the centre outwards towards the lower coastal areas (1 mark).	2
8(d)	The Indian Ocean	1
8(e)	Approximately 2,000 km	1
9(a)	Chinese Spring Festival (Gong Xi Fa Cai) / Chinese New Year	1
9(b)	Grand Bassin (Ganga Talao)	1
9(c)	October (Creole Day / Jounn Kréol Internasional is in October)	1
9(d)	"Motherland"	1
10(a)	Any valid festival with: correct name (1 mark); correct community (1 mark); description of how it is celebrated (1 mark). Examples: Diwali — Hindu community — lights, prayers, fireworks, sweets; Eid ul-Fitr — Muslim community — prayers, family meals, giving gifts; Christmas — Christian community — church services, decorations, family gatherings; Chinese New Year — Chinese community — lion/dragon dances, firecrackers, reunion dinners; Maha Shivaratri — Hindu community — pilgrimage to Grand Bassin, fasting, prayers.	3
10(b)	Any TWO from: it keeps the peace / prevents conflict between communities; everyone feels welcome and valued; Mauritius is stronger when all communities work together; tolerance builds a happier society; respecting others shows good character / values. (1 mark each)	2
10(c)	It means that Mauritius, despite having many different cultures, religions and languages, lives in peace and harmony — a model for other countries (1 mark). Any valid example: people from different religions celebrate each other's festivals;	1

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
	no major ethnic conflict in Mauritius; citizens of all backgrounds can hold office. (No additional mark required — the explanation earns the 1 mark.)	
Total		50

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